COMPLAINT COMPASS · WHEN THEY ASK “HOW WILL YOU SCALE THIS?”

Scalability: say it like you’re thinking out loud

About 60 seconds. Don’t read it word for word; the prompts below are enough.

> “So, first, the scale we’re talking about. Quick commerce in India does around seven point eight million orders a day. Even the complaints that get escalated to the government’s consumer helpline are significant: it was taking about five thousand calls a day by the end of last year, more than ten times what it got in 2015. In one year, Swiggy had about ninety-five hundred complaints registered there, Zomato about seven thousand, Flipkart over one and a half lakh. The complaints they handle directly are far larger, and those aren’t published. By our estimate it’s eighty thousand to two lakh a day in quick commerce alone.
>
> Now, the nice thing is the expensive part is already solved. Most complaints never touch the LLM, so cost grows in a straight line. At ten million complaints a month, it’s around four hundred dollars in model calls.
>
> On infrastructure, the classifying step doesn’t share any data, so we just add workers. One worker does roughly fifteen complaints a second. That eighty thousand to two lakh a day works out to only about one to three a second on average, so a company like Swiggy fits on a server or two.
>
> The only tricky bit is the issue list, because two workers could create the same issue twice. So each business area gets its own single writer, and they all run side by side. New customer? New partitions. One area gets slammed, like payments during an outage? We split it.
>
> Honestly, it’s not built at that scale yet. The first thing we’d do is load-test it.”

Or remember six prompts and talk

1. **The scale:** 7.8M quick-commerce orders a day; helpline ~5,000 calls a day; Swiggy ~9,500, Zomato ~7,000, Flipkart 1.6 lakh escalations a year. Escalations are a small slice; direct complaints aren’t published.
2. **Our estimate:** 80,000 to 2 lakh complaints a day in quick commerce, i.e. only 1–3 a second.
3. **Cost:** straight line, about $400 a month at 10 million complaints.
4. **Classifying:** no shared data, add workers; ~15 a second each, so a server or two per company.
5. **Issue list:** one writer per area; new customer = new partitions; a busy area gets split.
6. **Honesty:** not built at scale yet; load test first.

Only if they ask for detail

Escalated to the government, FY24	Per year	Per day
Flipkart	1,60,857	~440
Amazon	58,875	~160
Swiggy	9,527	~26
Zomato	6,983	~19
Blinkit	1,244	~3
All e-commerce	4,45,960	~1,200
RBI Ombudsman (FY25, banking)	13.34 lakh	~3,650

Volume a month	Workers	Partitions	Model cost
1M (one business)	2	7	$43
10M (~10 businesses)	2–4	~70	$433
100M (~100 businesses)	13–16	~700	$4,330

Throughput projected from latencies measured on the live run; model cost = $4.33 per 100,000 (measured) × volume, hosting excluded.

Sources: Storyboard18 citing the Consumer Affairs Ministry's FY24 data (company figures); PIB, 14 Mar 2025 (1,55,138 helpline calls in Dec 2024); The Tribune/ANI (RBI); GAEE report citing RedSeer (7.8M orders a day, Jan 2026). "80,000 to 2 lakh a day" is our estimate assuming 1–3% of orders lead to a complaint. Don't quote unverified 2025 company figures (e.g. Zepto 5,774).